



THE ITQAN WAY

From Vision to a Working School

A new Islamic secondary school · Stages 4–6 · Sydney

Where knowledge, action and faith are one journey — excellence as worship.

Dr Khaled Altarawneh · Head of School (Founding Appointment)

This school is an ***Amanah*** — a trust — honoured through ***Itqan***: mastery in the real craft of learning.

Knowledge ('ilm), action ('amal) and character (iman) are one journey, not three subjects — joined by the pursuit of excellence as worship. Rigorous because of the tradition; registrable because assurance is built in from day one.

Manhal

Mind — the wellspring

'Amal

Hands — knowledge into action

Athar

Heart — the evidence we leave

Four interlocking layers



Manhal

The wellspring. Every NESA outcome as a self-paced, mastery-gated node — study on demand.



'Amal Projects

Where knowledge becomes action. One real, interdisciplinary project a term, co-designed with mentors.



Kitab Maftuh

The world as an open book. Studios, mosques, councils and workplaces as real learning sites.



Athar Portfolio

The evidence. Application, reflection and contribution — the inspector's cleanest audit trail.

Aisha — routine, relationship, mastery

Aisha, Year 7 — highest structure, mostly face-to-face



MORNING

Usrah

Spiritual anchor + the day's plan with her Murabbi.



MID-MORNING

Knowledge sprint

A Guide teaches ratio & proportion — her project needs it.



BLOCK 2

Self-paced Manhal

Masters two nodes; coach checks at each gate.



AFTERNOON

'Amal studio

Builds a fair water-roster for the school garden with peers.



CLOSE

Reflect to Athar

Logs a short reflection to her portfolio.

Takeaway *Plus a fortnightly Kitab Maftuh community visit. Nothing is busywork — every task builds or proves knowledge.*

Yusuf — depth, independence, first mentors

Yusuf, Year 10 — more independence, deeper discipline, RoSA evidence building



MORNING

Usrah check-in

Sets his own week with his Murabbi.



2 MORNINGS / WK

Kitab Maftuh

Off-site at a council sustainability office.



JUST-IN-TIME

Manhal

Pulls heat-transfer & water-cycle nodes when the calcs need them.



BOOKED

Tutorial

With the science Guide, on the part he's stuck on.



WEEKLY

Writing sprint + 1:1

Technical-report sprint; fortnightly deep 1:1 with his Murabbi.

Takeaway *His dataset, model, client feedback and reflection on adab all build toward his RoSA.*

Mariam — flexibility, with the HSC in view

Mariam, Year 12 — highest flexibility, sustained internship, capstone



~1 DAY / WK

Internship

Real workplace tasks via Kitab Maftuh.



SELF-DIRECTED

Manhal

Manages most of her own learning.



SCHEDULED

HSC sprint

Board Developed Course preparation.



TERM-LONG

Riyadah capstone

Supervised by a Guide + an industry mentor.



FORTNIGHTLY

Usrah + 1:1

Coaching on pace, HSC and capstone.

Takeaway She sits the HSC AND graduates with an Athar portfolio and a real professional reference — a young leader, ready to serve.

“The Cool Courtyard”

The brief

Design a passive-cooling, water-wise courtyard — and an ablution-water re-use concept — for a partner community mosque.

Presented to **the mosque committee and a council sustainability officer.**

One term • cross-disciplinary • public Majlis exhibition



Real client

a genuine community need



Real consequence

ilm naafi' — beneficial knowledge



Real partners

industry & community as co-designers

Nothing falls through the cracks

Phase / weeks	Knowledge pulled (just-in-time)	Artefact (evidence)	Bloom	NESA areas
Empathise (1-2)	client brief; sustainability; urban heat	Brief & needs analysis	Understand	English; Geography
Investigate (2-4)	measurement; scale drawing; data	Site dataset + scaled plan	Apply	Maths; Science
Sprint (4-6)	heat transfer; water cycle; cooling	Thermal & water calcs	Analyse	Science; Maths
Prototype (6-8)	design thinking; materials; CAD	CAD + model; costed proposal	Create	Design & Tech
Communicate (8-9)	report structure; oracy; data viz	Report + client pitch	Evaluate	English
Majlis (10)	synthesis	Exhibition + reflection	Create	Cross-KLA; values

Takeaway *Knowledge arrives exactly when it is needed — and every artefact is traceable to a mandatory NESA outcome.*

Rigorous and registrable



The Manhal IS the curriculum

Explicit, knowledge-rich content — not 'soft on knowledge'. Simply made navigable and mastery-gated.



A coverage audit = no gaps

Every mandatory outcome maps to a node and a portfolio point; an automated audit flags anything unscheduled.



The Athar portfolio = the audit trail

The cleanest evidence a NESa inspection can be given — stronger than a timetable.



Honest on exams

No formal exams in Stages 4–5 (RoSA). HSC external exams are still sat in Stage 6 — wrapped inside Riyadhah projects.

Start small, prove, scale

Open with Year 7 only — then add one year-level a year.



- Defers HSC accreditation ~4–5 years
- A smaller Year-1 tree, team and capital outlay
- Time to prove the model on a small cohort before scaling

***“Open one year group well
— not a whole school.”***

THE GRADUATE

A deep generalist — capable and grounded



Scholar

ilm



Maker

problem-solver



Steward

amanah · adab



Communicator

oracy & writing



Self-directed

metacognition



Person of character

Tarbiyah

I have built and run this — at Charles Sturt, UniSA and UTS. What I bring is the rare combination of having built the architecture, and being able to anchor it in why we educate at all.

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